Manel Leiva

Senior Product Designer

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Barcelona

SUMMARY

Senior Product Designer with 15 years of experience designing complex B2B products, specialising in data-heavy workflows, information architecture, product systems and cross-functional delivery.

Experienced in taking ambiguous problems from discovery through design and implementation. Designed and launched a production AI agent to every customer, defining its safe capability boundaries, evidence-based response patterns, and post-release feedback loop for complex compensation data. Strong partner to Product and Engineering, including experience as a sole designer.

EXPERIENCE

Senior Product Designer

Remuner

May 2024 - Mar 2026 · Barcelona, hybrid

- Designed and launched a production conversational AI agent for sales-compensation questions, defining capability boundaries, safe refusal behavior, evidence-based answer formats, and trust patterns for sensitive financial data.
- Validated conversational formats with users before launch and ran a weekly post-release feedback loop using captured conversations and explicit user feedback to improve response formats, terminology, and trust.
- Built a production design system from scratch as sole designer; by departure, 10 of 18 core product screens used system components, backed by a token pipeline with CI validation and engineering review.

Senior Product Designer

Abacum

Jan 2022 - Apr 2024 · Barcelona, hybrid

- Tested a new self-serve Dataset Manager directly with customers, translating JSON/schema configuration into finance-team language and guardrails that prevented invalid downstream states.
- Reduced implementation-team time spent on standard dataset configuration by roughly half and enabled customers to reach a working configuration in their first session.

- Led research and design for a consistent formula language across the modelling layer, using customer-call evidence and competitor benchmarking to establish shared syntax decisions with Engineering.

Senior Product Designer & Co-founder

Kings of Mambo

Sep 2010 - Nov 2021 · Barcelona, hybrid

- Co-founded and led a UX studio for 11 years; designed products for media, retail, finance, legal, and culture clients.
- Built much of what I designed, including CMS-connected WordPress themes, front-end component libraries, and a shared starter kit with a build pipeline and CSS variables.
- Taught UX and digital design at postgraduate level, including taking a design file through to a working CMS-driven site.

SKILLS

Product Design: Complex workflows, information architecture, interaction design, product discovery, prototyping, usability testing
Research: Customer interviews, qualitative synthesis, structured user testing, Jobs To Be Done, competitor benchmarking
AI: AI interaction design, conversational interfaces, AI-assisted workflows, trust and accuracy patterns
Design Systems: Design tokens, component architecture, contribution standards, Token Studio, Style Dictionary, Storybook, Chromatic
Collaboration: Product & Engineering partnership, stakeholder alignment, cross-functional facilitation, design critique
Technical: Figma, GitHub, npm, VS Code, Vercel, HTML/CSS, front-end collaboration

EDUCATION

Higher National Diploma in Computing Design and Multimedia

ESI (Escuela de Sistemas Informáticos)

2002